happens in all cases within our experience. As the multitude of the natural phenomena observed in all fields unfolds in an ever richer and more variegated profusion, the scientific world picture, which is derived from them, assumes an always clearer and more definite form. The continuing changes in the world picture do not therefore signify an erratic oscillation in a zigzag line, but a progress, an improvement, a completion. In establishing this fact I have, in my opinion, indicated the basically most important accomplishment that scientific research can claim.

But what is the direction of this progress, and what is its ultimate goal? The direction, evidently, is the constant improvement of the world picture by reducing the real elements contained in it to a higher reality of a less naive character. The goal, on the other hand, is the creation of a world picture, with real elements which no longer require an improvement, and therefore represent the ultimate reality. A demonstrable attainment of this goal will—or can—never be ours. But in order to have at least a name for it, for the time being, we call the ultimate reality "the real world," in the absolute, metaphysical sense of the word, *real.* This is to be construed as expressing the fact that the *real* world—in other words, objective nature —stands behind everything explorable. In contrast to it, the scientific world picture gained by experience—the *phenomenological world*—remains always a mere approximation, a more or less well divined model. As there is a material object behind every sensation, so there is a metaphysical reality behind everything that human experience shows to be real. Many philosophers object to the word, "*behind*." They say: "Since in exact science all concepts and all measures are reducible to sensations, in the last analysis the meaning of every scientific finding also refers only to the sense world, and it is inadmissible, or at least superfluous, to postulate the existence behind this world of a metaphysical world, totally inaccessible to direct scientific inquiry and examination." The only proper reply to this argument is, simply, that in the above sentence the word, *behind,* must not be interpreted in an external or spatial sense. Instead of "behind," we could just as well say, "*in*" or "*within.*" Metaphysical reality does not stand spatially *behind* what is given in experience, but lies fully *within* it. "Nature is neither core nor shell—she is everything at once." The essential point is that the world of sensation is not the only world which may conceivably exist, but that there is still another world. To be sure, this other world is not directly accessible to us, but its existence is indicated, time and again, with compelling clarity, not only by practical life, but also by the labors of science. For the great marvel of the scientific world picture, becoming progressively more complete and perfect, necessarily impels the investigator to seek its ultimate form. And since one must assume the existence of that which one seeks, the scientist's assumption of the actual existence of a "real world," in the absolute sense of the word,